

ERIC BENNETT

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RESEARCH INTERESTS

Multilingual NLP, Large Language Model (LLM) Evaluation, Machine Translation, Low-Resource NLP, Interdisciplinary NLP

EDUCATION

Northeastern University, Khoury College of Computer Sciences September 2026 - Present
Ph.D. Student, Computer Science
Advised by Terra Blevins and David Smith

University of Maryland, College of Computer, Mathematical, and Natural Sciences Graduation: May 2026
Bachelor of Science in Computer Science, Machine Learning Specialization GPA: 3.48
Bachelor of Arts in Chinese

National Taiwan University January 2025 - June 2025

- Attended Chinese language courses and Computer Science courses taught in Mandarin.

National Taiwan Normal University June 2023 - August 2023

- Recipient of Huayu BEST Scholarship for Chinese Summer Language and Literature study abroad program.
- Competed in a Chinese speech competition with the topic of “The Impact of AI on Humans.”

Relevant Coursework

- Natural Language Processing (NLP), Deep Reinforcement Learning, Machine Learning, Artificial Intelligence, Linear Algebra, Chinese Language II (Accelerated), Object Oriented Programming I & II, Algorithms, Database Design

PUBLICATIONS

Evaluating Evaluation Metrics for Ancient Chinese to English Machine Translation May 2025
Eric Bennett, HyoJung Han, Xincheng Yang, Andrew Schonebaum, Marine Carpuat

- Evaluated standard (BLEU, CHRF) and neural (COMET, METRICX) machine translation evaluation metrics using a human-validated contrastive test set of synthetic base translations and intentionally flawed translations. Results demonstrate neural metrics’ robustness on language pairs not seen in training.

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Laboratory of Analytical Sciences, NC State University College Park, MD
Summer Research Scholar February 2024 - Present

- Exploring translation of Classical Chinese texts using LLMs under a \$100,000 seed grant from the Artificial Intelligence Interdisciplinary Institute at Maryland advised by Dr. Marine Carpuat alongside Dr. Andrew Schonebaum in the Department of East Asian Languages and Cultures.
- Investigating LLM-as-a-judge methods of machine translation evaluation for domain-specific translation through a meta-analysis of metrics based on a dataset of controlled perturbations specific to the Classical Chinese to English language pair.
- Developing an interactive web platform to host LLM translations of Classical Chinese texts from the Daizhige corpus, enabling bilingual paragraph-level alignment, search, and navigation for scholars without expertise in Classical Chinese.
- Organizing a weekly reading group on multilingual NLP, coordinating with international group members and hosting invited speakers to present cutting-edge research in the field.

UMD Computational Linguistics and Information Processing Laboratory (CLIP) College Park, MD
Research Assistant February 2024 – May 2026

- Exploring translation of Classical Chinese texts using LLMs under a \$100,000 seed grant from the Artificial Intelligence Interdisciplinary Institute at Maryland advised by Dr. Marine Carpuat alongside Dr. Andrew Schonebaum in the Department of East Asian Languages and Cultures.
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Gemstone Honors Research Program

Research Assistant

College Park, MD

August 2022 – May 2026

- Conducting analysis on hundreds of university course syllabi to quantify the rise of institutional and instructor-level recognition and sentiment towards the usage of generative AI tools in the classroom under advisors Dr. Jing Liu and Dr. Lucas Butler.

Special Competitive Studies Project

Research Assistant

Arlington, VA

June 2025 - August 2025

- Analyzed data regarding U.S.-China competition in emerging tech sectors including artificial intelligence, nuclear fusion, quantum computing, and 6G through an analysis of a novel dataset of 14+ years of Chinese state media output comprised of over 110 million words.
- Created data visualization published in the New York Times regarding U.S.-China competition in publications in the Nuclear Fusion journal, highlighting a sharp rise in Chinese publications since 2010.
- Evaluated structural and regulatory constraints on LLM development in China compared to the U.S. through the development of an interactive policy simulation used to highlight dilemmas faced by Chinese AI developers.

Johns Hopkins University Applied Physics Laboratory

Research Assistant

Laurel, MD

June 2021 - June 2022

- Conducted research and presented a report on the State of Coronavirus Research Prior to the COVID-19 Pandemic, utilizing bibliometric models to create data visualizations based on research database metadata.

PROJECTS

Cognitive Alignment – Reducing Order Bias in MCQ Answering

- Developed a novel approach to mitigate order bias in multiple-choice question answering by LLMs by decoupling answer selection from answer order, using free-response generation followed by semantic matching against answer choices via sentence-transformer embeddings.
- Reduced order bias by 22% (RSD) on English MMLU tasks across models tested (GPT-4o, Mistral-Small) using standard order bias metrics (RSD, RStd, FR) with smaller but consistent improvements in Mandarin.

Classical Chinese Translation Tool

- Developed a translation interface used by UMD faculty to translate large-scale corpora of Classical Chinese, including full-length novels, implementing intelligent, automatic chunking and model-agnostic translation through proprietary APIs and locally deployed LLMs using Ollama.
- Designed marker-based alignment system enabling precise navigation between original and translated segments, facilitating downstream annotation and allowing users to maintain philological accuracy.

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Howard County Public School System, Chinese Tutor

September 2025 - Present

- Tutoring Chinese II at the middle school level through weekly one-on-one sessions using personalized lessons that emphasize oral proficiency, spaced repetition, and application-based vocabulary retention.

AWARDS

UMD Omicron Delta Kappa Honor Society: University of Maryland Top Ten Freshmen Award

UMD School of Languages, Literatures, and Cultures: Tsung Chin Chinese Calligraphy Scholarship Recipient

UMD: President's Scholarship Recipient

Boy Scouts of America: Eagle Scout Award

ORGANIZATIONS

- Tea Club at the University of Maryland, Cofounder
- Chris and Eric's Small Batch Pickles, Cofounder